

Networking Planning document review

Planning Document Review: Networking Team (Group 1: November)

Timing Issues and Missed Milestones

- **Completion Date Consistency:** All major components (NetworkManager, GameServerManager, DatabaseManager) are expected to be completed before Iteration 2. However, no specific breakdown of internal milestones is provided. This could cause delays if problems happen near the end of the development process.
- **Ambiguous Integration Timeline:** While the document mentions combining networking components with other parts (game logic, GUI, Authentication), no explicit timeline is provided for these integrations. Delayed integration could create last-minute conflicts.

Risks Impacting Completion

- **Dependency Management:** GameServerManager depends on the Game Logic and Matchmaking modules. Delays in these areas could prevent timely completion.
- **Unspecified Testing Strategy:** There is no clear mention of how networking features (e.g., player messaging and game state syncing) will be tested across multiple client simulations. Without multiple and strong testing, there is a risk of undetected synchronization issues.
- **Resource Allocation:** No explicit mention of task distribution within the group, which could lead to uneven workloads and delays.

Suggestions for Improvement

1. **Staggered Milestones:** Implement incremental deadlines for major deliverables (e.g., GameServerManager prototype by mid-Iteration 1, full testing by early-Iteration 2).
2. **Early Integration:** Begin integration testing as each major component is completed rather than waiting until the end of Iteration 2.
3. **Task Assignment:** Clearly outline individual responsibilities to prevent overlapping efforts and ensure even workload distribution.
4. **Testing Framework:** Establish a structured testing approach (unit tests for each class, integration tests for full player-server communication).

General Recommendations

- **Cross-Team Communication:** Ensure regular updates between groups to align stub implementation with actual networking design.
- **Documentation Updates:** Regularly update planning documents to reflect changes, especially if milestones or tasks shift.
- **Proactive Risk Management:** Identify and address risks early (e.g., incomplete testing, unclear dependencies) through regular reviews and feedback cycles.